



Elijah Olson

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Education

The University of California, Merced:

Bachelors in Computer Science and Computer Engineering, Minor in Philosophy 05/2026

Saint Mary's College High School:

High School Diploma 05/2022

Skills

- Coding Languages: C++, C#, HTML, Python, Django, React, JavaScript, Kotlin, IntelliJ
- Leadership, Management, and Adaptability
- Written and Verbal Work Communication
- Critical Thinking and Problem Solving
- Project Engineering and Design
- Coordination and Team Collaboration
- Rock Climbing, Culinary, and Poetry

STEM Experience

Website and Data Technician / UC Merced 09/2025 - Current

- Revitalized and maintained the CEC website (Drupal CMS), optimizing accessibility, accuracy, and user experience while amplifying visibility of programs and events.
- Engineered and launched surveys and registration systems that streamlined data capture and improved participation tracking across community initiatives.
- Transformed raw engagement data into clear summaries and visualizations, driving program evaluation, strategic planning, and continuous improvement.

Neural Simulation Architect and Documentation Writer / SIMBRAIN 06/2025 - Current

- Designed, built, and documented interactive simulations across neuroscience, machine learning, cognitive science, and evolutionary systems using Kotlin and the Simbrain platform, integrating diverse update rules, learning algorithms, and data-driven architectures with a focus on conceptual clarity and cross-disciplinary insight.
- Contributed to Simbrain's core simulation library and documentation, enhancing its usability, pedagogical value, and accessibility for both new users and advanced researchers.

Fullstack Engineer Intern / Patient Safety 06/2024 - 08/2024

- Developed and maintained backend systems using Python, focusing on data analysis, algorithm development, and database management.
- Created responsive and interactive front-end interfaces with React, Django, and JS.
- Ensured seamless integration between the backend and front end, enabling real-time data flow and user interactivity.
- Collaborated with other engineers to optimize application performance and deliver user-friendly solutions.

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Research Assistant / UC Merced

11/2023 - 03/2024

- Architecting algorithms using a linear search to read and transcribe large sets of electroencephalogram (EEG) data for sensory studies.
- Identifying features and patterns to create usable data for analysis.
- Analyzing the electrical activity patterns within the human brain to decode the sensory experiences of study participants.

Software Engineer Intern / Tappity INC

04/2020 - 10/2021

- Developed interactive features for a science education app, boosting user engagement and retention among K-8 students.
- Collaborated with full-stack engineers to design and implement new experiential learning activities, integrating front-end functionality with backend systems.
- Leveraged knowledge of child development to inform feature design, enhancing educational value and user experience for a young audience.

Leadership Experience / Bay Area

- Project Manager, Private Home Remodeling (06/2023 - 08/2023): Managed the scheduling and work process of various trade specialists.
- Landscaping Assistant, ECO SCAPES (09/2019 - 06/2020): Co-drafted, constructed, and maintained landscape designs.
- Childcare Provider Service, Freelance (12/2017 - 07/2020): Extended childcare, activity planning, and tutoring for children aged 6-12.
- Camp Counselor, JCC Kids Summer Camp (06-08, 2017-2019): Supervised 20+ children ages 6-13 in daily camp activities.

Projects (all on LinkedIn or GitHub)

- Violet, a personalized course creator and teacher, using public LLM APIs, initially created for a Hackathon, winning 3rd place, yet continues to be a personal project.
- Unbeatable Tic Tac Toe AI with adjustable settings and difficulties
- Third Dimensional Bowling Alley using Unity and C#, allowing the player to experience accurate functionality within the alley, be it with bowling balls, bowling pins, etc.
- 2D replica of the popular game, Flappy Bird
- 2D replica of one of my favorite games, Tetris

Relevant Coursework

- Math: Calculus I-III, Discrete Mathematics, Statistics & Probabilities, Linear Algebra, Linear Analysis
 - Computer Science: Data Structures and Design Patterns, Computer Organization and Architecture, Algorithm Design and Analysis, Full-stack, Web Development, Natural Image Processing,
 - Philosophy: Philosophy of Science, Tech Ethics, Metaphysics, Contemporary Ethics, Modern Philosophy, Ancient Philosophy, Philosophy of the Human Mind
 - Other: AP English Literature, Physics, Visual Arts and Design, Numerical Economics Macro and Micro, Static and Dynamic Engineering, Circuit Theory
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